BUYER'S GUIDE · 01

A carbon credit is only as good as *the project behind it.*

Four questions to ask
before your company buys one.

? **Who certified it?**

? **Would it have happened anyway?**

SWIPE →

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So, what is *a carbon credit?*

A tradable certificate for **one tonne of CO_2e** that a project avoided or removed, checked against a published standard.

Issued

by a third-party standard

Traded

through a marketplace

Retired

once claimed, never resold

Source: Verra VCS and Gold Standard programme rules (unit definitions).

FOR YOUR TEAM

Four questions *to ask the seller.*

Which standard issued it?

Ask for the registry and serial number.

Is it additional?

Would the cut have happened without it?

How long does it last?

Check how reversal risk is handled.

Can you see it retired?

In your company's name, on the public registry.

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— THE HONEST PART

Credits help. They are *not a substitute for cutting emissions.*

> *Reduce what you can first. Use credits for what you can't yet.*

Please note: Carbon credits do not eliminate emissions and should be used as part of a broader decarbonization strategy.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Ask four questions. *Buy with confidence.*

NEXT IN THIS SERIES

How a credit gets retired, and why it matters.

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Credits listed on this platform are issued and certified by third-party standards. The Green Solve acts as a marketplace facilitator.